

UPSC Mains Answer Evaluation Report

Comprehensive AI-Generated Assessment

Score Summary

Mode: critical

4.5/10 Total Score	General Studies Paper I Paper	10 Question Marks
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Detailed Scorecard (1+6+2+1 = 10)

Introduction

0.25/1

There is NO separate introduction paragraph. The candidate starts directly with the heading 'Reasons for Sending Cripps Mission (March 1940)'. In a 10-marker answer, a 2-3 line contextual introduction is essential.

Areas to Improve:

- Missing formal introduction paragraph.

Suggested approach: "In March 1942, the British government dispatched the Cripps Mission, headed by Sir Stafford Cripps, to secure Indian cooperation in World War II against the backdrop of Japanese advance in South-East Asia."

Body

The body addresses all three required sub-parts (Reasons for sending, Proposals, and Causes of failure) in a structured manner. However, it contains multiple severe factual inaccuracies regarding dates (1940 instead of 1942, July 1941 Burma) and misinterprets certain legal clauses (attributing secession rights to 'minorities' rather than 'provinces'). Depth of analysis on political dynamics (Churchill's reluctance, veto power of Viceroy, defence portfolio dispute) is missing.

Strengths:

- + Covered all sub-questions systematically using clear headings.
- + Categorized objections from various groups (INC, Muslim League, Sikhs, Depressed Classes, Princely States).

Areas to Improve:

- Glaring date errors in Modern History (1940 instead of 1942).
Suggested approach: "Ensure chronological accuracy: August Offer (1940) -> Cripps Mission (1942) -> Quit India (1942)."
- Imprecise description of constitutional proposals.
Suggested approach: "Specify: Dominion status after war, Constituent Assembly with elected provincial representatives and nominated princely state members, non-accession clause for provinces, and British control over defence during wartime."
- Written "March 1940" for Cripps Mission sending date.
Suggested approach: "Cripps Mission was dispatched in March 1942 (March 1940 was the Ramgarh INC Session / August offer came in Aug 1940)."
- Written Japanese advance in Burma as "July 1941".
Suggested approach: "Japan invaded Burma in December 1941 and Rangoon fell in March 1942."
- Claimed proposal included "Rights of Minorities to secede".
Suggested approach: "The proposal gave option to 'Provinces' (not minorities) to not accept the Constitution and form a separate Union."
- Quoted Gandhi as saying "post-dated cheque on a crashing Bank".
Suggested approach: "Gandhi called it a 'post-dated cheque'. The phrase 'on a crashing bank' was appended by later commentators."
- British internal political dynamics and executive unwillingness.
Suggested approach: "Include Allied pressure (Roosevelt, Chiang Kai-shek), Labour leaders in War Cabinet (Attlee), but highlight Winston Churchill and Viceroy Linlithgow's rigid opposition to transferring actual power or defence portfolio during the war."

Conclusion

1/2

The conclusion connects the failure of the Cripps Mission to the launch of the Quit India Movement on August 8, 1942. However, it is written as a single line at the end of the points rather than a synthesized forward-looking paragraph.

Strengths:

- + Accurately links the failure of the mission to the immediate historic trigger for the Quit India Movement on 8th August 1942.

Areas to Improve:

- Abrupt ending without analyzing the shift in Indian national movement strategy.

Suggested approach: "Explain how the failure marked a paradigm shift from conditional cooperation/negotiated settlement to unconditional demand for immediate British withdrawal ('Quit India' / 'Do or Die')."

Presentation

0.75/1

Handwriting is legible and neat. Headings and numbered points make the structure easy to navigate. However, line margins are slightly tight and lack of a proper intro hurts overall layout.

Answer Sheet - Page 1

Examiner Comments

1. Factual Error

"Reasons for Sending Cripps Mission (March 1940)"

Major factual error: Cripps Mission was sent in March 1942, NOT March 1940. March 1940 was the Ramgarh Session / Lahore Resolution era.

Suggested approach: "Reasons for sending Cripps Mission (March 1942)"

2. Poor Structure

"Why was the Cripps Mission sent to India? Explain its proposals & reasons for it..."

Missing formal introduction. Jumping straight into heading/points without defining Cripps Mission (led by Sir Stafford Cripps, Cabinet Minister under Prime Minister Winston Churchill, March 1942) reduces context quality.

Suggested approach: "The Cripps Mission was sent to India in March 1942, headed by Sir Stafford Cripps, to secure full Indian cooperation and..."

3. Factual Error

"Burma in July 1941"

Inaccurate date for Japanese advance in Southeast Asia/Burma. Japan invaded Burma in December 1941 - early 1942 (Rangoon fell in March 1942), not 'July 1941'. In July 1941 Japan occupied Southern Indochina.

Suggested approach: "Japanese rapid advance in Southeast Asia and threat to Indian borders (fall of Rangoon in March 1942)."

4. Missing Depth

"Pressure from the allies - US, china to secure Indian support"

Good identification of key reasons (Allied pressure from US FDR & China Chiang Kai-shek, Japanese threat, failure of August Offer 1940), but missed internal British political context (Labour Party pressure in War Cabinet).

Suggested approach: "Also mention pressure from British Labour Party members in the War Cabinet (e.g., Clement Attlee) and threat of Japanese..."

Examiner Comments (continued)

5. Factual Error

"Rights of Minorities to secede from India if their interests are not protected."

Factual inaccuracy: 'Rights of Minorities to secede' was not a distinct proposal. The proposal allowed 'provinces' the option to not join the Union (non-accession clause), which implicitly allowed creation of another Dominion (partition idea).

Suggested approach: "Provinces unwilling to join the Union could form a separate Constitution and union. Provision for defence remaining unde..."

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Registration No.		Classroom Assignment Sheet		Assignment Code	
46704254				184997	
Name: ARYANT KUMAR				Total Marks	
Subject: HLT		Batch: B33		Submission Date: 14/8/2026	
Question: Why was the Cripps Mission sent to India? Explain its proposals & reasons for its failure.					
<u>Reasons for Sending Cripps Mission (March 1940)</u>					
① Failure of August offer (1940) to secure Indian cooperation in the world war-II.					
② Japanese advance in southeast Asia, especially in Burma in July 1941.					
③ Fall of France, Ireland.					
④ Pressure from the allies - US, China to secure Indian support.					
<u>Proposals</u>					
① Dominion status to be granted to India after the war is over.					
② Setup of a constituent assembly which will be elected to decide the constitutional fate of India.					
③ Indian union will not be imposed on princely state and the princely state unwilling to join the union can have a separate constitution.					
④ Provinces having the right to secede from the union of India.					
⑤ Rights of Minorities to secede from India if their interests are not protected.					

Answer Sheet - Page 2

Examiner Comments

1. Factual Error

""post-dated cheque on a crashing Bank""

Factually incorrect quote. Mahatma Gandhi called it a 'post-dated cheque'. The phrase 'on a crashing bank' was added by later commentators/journalists, not Gandhi himself.

Suggested approach: "Gandhi termed the proposal a "post-dated cheque" (referring to Dominion status offered after the war)."

2. Inadequate Example

"Muslim league opposed the method of accession"

Accurately identified key objections across political groups (INC wanting immediate transfer of real power & defence; Muslim League wanting explicit recognition of Pakistan/partition; Princely states/Sikhs/Depressed Classes concerns).

Suggested approach: "Mention that Muslim League rejected it because it did not explicitly concede Pakistan/partition, though the non-accessio..."

3. Missing Depth

"Depressed classes feared to be dominated by Hindus."

Crucial missing reason: Linlithgow and Churchill's lack of genuine intent to share real power, and refusal to grant immediate Cabinet status/defence portfolio to Indian leaders during wartime.

Suggested approach: "Viceroy Linlithgow and PM Churchill's rigid stance against granting actual Cabinet-style responsible government or defen..."

4. Marks Awarded

"Thus, the failure of Cripps Mission became one of the strong reasons for INC to ..."

Appropriate concluding remark linking Cripps failure directly to the launch of the Quit India Movement in August 1942. Could be enhanced by adding the shift from cooperation to unconditional demand for immediate British withdrawal.

2

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⑥ The Governor General to retain control of Defence, Communication, Foreign Affairs, Finance.

Causes of Failure

① No clear method of accession was defined, leading to questions on the treaty of transfer of power.

② Rejections from major political factions of India-

a) INC - Gandhi called it a 'post-dated cheque on a crashing Bank'. The right to secede from Indian union worked against the principle of National unity.

b) INC's real demand was complete independence.

c) The representatives of princely states were nominated instead of being elected.

d) Muslim League opposed the method of accession.

e) Sikhs feared that partition would take Punjab away from them.

f) Depressed classes feared to be dominated by Hindus.

Thus, the failure of Cripps Mission became one of the strong reasons for INC to launch the massive Quit India Movement on 8th August 1942.

For Official use only - Evaluation Feedback: Please put tick marks in this table

	Context	Content	Structure - presentation	Language	Word limit	Overall performance
Excellent						
Good						
Average						

Personalized Improvement Strategy

Performance Summary

The answer covers the basic structure and addresses all sub-parts of the prompt. However, it suffers from prominent factual errors regarding dates (1940 instead of 1942 for Cripps Mission, July 1941 for Burma), lacks a proper introduction, and misattributes historical details/quotes. Factual precision in Modern History is paramount for UPSC Mains.

Key Strengths

- + Covered all three core sub-parts of the question (Reasons, Proposals, Causes of Failure).
- + Categorized causes of failure across different political entities (INC, Muslim League, Sikhs, Depressed Classes).
- + Good concluding line connecting the failure to the launch of the Quit India Movement (8th August 1942).

Critical Weaknesses

- Factual slip-ups on major dates (writing March 1940 instead of March 1942 for Cripps Mission; July 1941 for Burma occupation).
- Lack of a formal introduction defining the context, key leaders (Stafford Cripps, Churchill, Linlithgow), and the overarching historical significance.
- Incomplete depth on key causes of failure—specifically the role of Viceroy Linlithgow and Winston Churchill's unwillingness to concede real cabinet power or control over defence during the war.

Study Recommendations

- Refer to NCERT Class XII / Spectrum's 'A Brief History of Modern India' chapter on 'National Movement Towards Freedom & Partition (1939-1947)'.
- Memorize precise dates and key terms of constitutional offers (August Offer 1940, Cripps Mission 1942, Wavell Plan 1945, Cabinet Mission 1946).

Immediate Action Plan

1. [HIGH] Thoroughly double-check historical dates before writing, especially prominent events like Cripps Mission (1942), August Offer (1940), Cabinet Mission (1946).

Impact: Eliminating glaring factual errors builds immediate examiner trust and prevents severe mark deductions.

2. [MEDIUM] Always frame a concise 2-3 line definition/context introduction instead of directly jumping into subheadings.

Impact: Improves structure, presentation score, and flow of answer.

3. [HIGH] Include administrative and political constraints (e.g., Churchill's reluctance, Viceroy's veto, power-sharing over Defence) in historical failure analysis.

Impact: Adds analytical depth required for higher marks in GS-1 History.